Perioperative Identity, Consent, and Team Verification

NURSING · nursing-foundations · BoardPrep lesson v1

Official examination scope

PRC Resolution No. 10 s. 2025 and the August 2026 NLE program define examination scope, not topic weights. This lesson teaches a bounded perioperative safety verification foundation from the references below. Open RN and U.S. professional materials support general educational principles only; apply Philippine law, scope of practice, current clinical orders, referral pathways, and facility policy. This study material is not a clinical directive or proof of complete NP coverage.

Learning objectives

- Apply a team verification pause to discrepancies in identity, intended procedure/site,
- documentation, or the patient’s expressed understanding.
- Distinguish the nurse’s safety role from the authorized clinician’s responsibility to explain
- and obtain consent under current law and policy.
- Communicate unresolved discrepancies and do not allow schedule pressure to substitute for
- verification.

1. Stop and resolve a mismatch before proceeding

Before a procedure, team verification checks that the patient, intended procedure and site, available documentation, and the patient’s understanding align. A patient saying the planned operation differs from what was discussed is a meaningful discrepancy, not a routine question to dismiss. Pause the process, confirm identity and the available consent record, and bring the concern to the proceduralist and responsible team under local policy. The nurse supports understanding, patient questions, and a safe pause; this lesson does not define who may legally obtain consent, substitute decision-making rules, required forms, or Philippine operating-room procedure. Continue only after the authorized team resolves the mismatch and the patient’s rights are respected.

Sources for this section

Section reference: WHO Surgical Safety Checklist and Implementation Manual — World Health Organization — https://www.who.int/publications/i/item/9789241598590
Section reference: Nursing Fundamentals — Open RN; Wisconsin Technical Colleges System — https://wtcs.pressbooks.pub/nursingfundamentals/

Resolve a procedure discrepancy

Question: Immediately before surgery, a patient says the planned procedure is different from what was discussed.
1. Stop the progression to the next procedural step and listen to the patient’s concern.
2. Verify identity, available consent and procedure/site documentation, then notify the authorized proceduralist and team.
3. Resume only through the current local process after the discrepancy and patient questions are resolved.
Answer: Pause and verify; do not proceed because the schedule is printed.
Check: The nurse does not invent consent authority or replace required local legal steps.

Common misconceptions

- A signed form does not make an expressed mismatch irrelevant.
- Time pressure is not evidence that identity, procedure, site, and understanding agree.

- The nursing safety pause does not transfer the authorized clinician’s consent
- responsibilities.

Practice patterns

- When the patient’s understanding conflicts with the planned procedure, stop, verify, and
- escalate to the authorized team.
- Treat the WHO checklist as a safety communication aid, not Philippine consent law.

Official scope references

Official scope: Enhanced Tables of Specifications for the Subjects in the Nurses Licensure Examination — Professional Regulation Commission; Professional Regulatory Board of Nursing — https://www.prc.gov.ph/sites/default/files/2025-10%20%20published%20Enhanced%20TOS%20nuse.pdf
Official scope: Nursing Licensure Examination Program, August 2026 — Professional Regulation Commission; Professional Regulatory Board of Nursing — https://www.prc.gov.ph/sites/default/files/exam%20progam%20aug%202026%20nle%20(nursing)%20signed.pdf

Instructional references

Instructional reference: WHO Surgical Safety Checklist and Implementation Manual — World Health Organization — https://www.who.int/publications/i/item/9789241598590
Instructional reference: Nursing Fundamentals — Open RN; Wisconsin Technical Colleges System — https://wtcs.pressbooks.pub/nursingfundamentals/

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